Credit Card Paydown Planner

A focused worksheet to lower utilization, protect savings, and prepare your credit profile.

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

Utilization targets, a paydown strategy, a sample worksheet, and mortgage-timing cautions.

PLAN • PAYDOWN • PREPARE

- ☑ Lower utilization
- ☑ Build stronger credit
- ☑ Protect your savings
- ☑ Prepare for your home loan

THIS PLANNER WILL HELP YOU:

- Understand how utilization impacts your score
- Create a smart paydown plan that fits your budget
- Use the worksheet to track and stay on target
- Avoid common mortgage-timing mistakes

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How to Use This Planner

This is not about paying every card to zero overnight — it's about improving your buying position without draining cash you may need for closing.

1. **List each card**
   Use nicknames only. Do not write account numbers.

2. **Find utilization**
   Divide balance by limit to see where each card stands.

3. **Choose targets**
   Prioritize cards over 30%, then work toward stronger goals.

4. **Protect cash**
   Ask before using savings that may be needed for down payment or closing.

PRIVACY NOTE Never write full card numbers, security codes, usernames, passwords, or logins on this planner.

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Why Utilization Matters

Utilization is the percentage of your available revolving credit that you are using.

0–9%	**Strong zone** Often a stronger place to be before applying.
10–29%	**Healthy target** A useful target for many buyers preparing their profile.
30–49%	**Watch zone** Worth reviewing before a mortgage conversation.
50%+	**Priority zone** Usually the first place to look for paydown impact.

SIMPLE FORMULA Balance ÷ credit limit = utilization. Example: $2,400 ÷ $6,000 = 40% utilization.

Choose the Right Paydown Method

There is no single best method for everyone — the right plan depends on your utilization, budget, and cash needs.

1. **Utilization first**
   Best when one or two cards are near their limits. Focus payments where the balance is highest vs. the limit.

2. **Small balance wins**
   Best when you need momentum. Clear smaller balances so fewer payments pull attention each month.

3. **Cash protection**
   Best when closing funds are tight. Make smaller strategic payments while preserving savings.

MORTGAGE-TIMING CAUTION Do not open, close, consolidate, or transfer credit accounts during the mortgage process without asking your loan team first.

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Sample Paydown Plan

This example turns a confusing set of balances into a clear action plan.

Card	Limit	Balance	Now	Target	Goal
Travel Card	$8,000	$5,600	70%	30%	$3,200
Store Card	$2,000	$1,100	55%	30%	$500
Everyday Card	$6,000	$1,200	20%	10%	$600

BIG IDEA The best plan is not always the biggest payment — it's the one that improves readiness while protecting the full homebuying strategy.

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Turn This Into a Plan

1. **Complete the worksheet**
   List card nicknames, balances, limits, and current utilization.

2. **Choose the first target**
   Focus on the card where paydown creates the clearest improvement.

3. **Review before big moves**
   Ask before using savings, opening or closing accounts, or transferring balances.

Let's create your plan together.

Schedule your free strategy call at movewithmaryv.com